

WILLIAM ELIAS

Senior DevOps / Platform Engineer

Building Automation, Reliable Platforms & AI-Enabled Operations

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior DevOps and Platform Engineer with 10+ years across infrastructure, networking, software QA, automation, production operations, and delivery engineering. Designs automation and platform capabilities that reduce repetitive operational work, standardize software delivery, and improve production reliability. Recent work includes standardizing CI/CD across a ~60-application estate, automating release and support workflows, strengthening observability and secrets management, and building AI-enabled operational tooling.

CORE EXPERTISE

DevOps & Delivery: Azure DevOps, CI/CD, YAML Pipelines, Classic Release, GitHub Actions, Release Automation, Git, Deployment Groups, Reusable Templates

Automation & Development: Python, PowerShell, C#, .NET, Go, REST APIs, FastAPI, SQL, ASP.NET Core

Reliability & Observability: Azure Monitor, Application Insights, KQL, Structured Logging, Incident Triage, RCA, Serilog, SLA Support

Infrastructure & Security: IIS, Windows Server, Active Directory, SQL Server, Docker, Helm, Azure Key Vault, Managed Identity, OAuth/IAM

AI-Enabled Engineering: MCP, RAG, ChromaDB, Vector Search, Multi-Agent Routing, LLM APIs, Human-in-the-Loop Workflows, Embeddings, AI Guardrails

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Stellantis Financial Services US

Feb 2023 - Present

Production Support Engineer - DevOps & Automation | Auburn Hills, MI · Remote

- Designed the standardized .NET CI/CD and release model for an approximately 60-application estate; created 56 Azure DevOps build/release definitions across 28 applications, with 27 of 28 builds verified green and 25 deployment plans dry-run validated on the deployment agent.
- Built repository-to-server/deployment-path inventory, artifact validation, and environment-readiness guardrails that identified six latent delivery defects, including application-pool identity convergence risk, before any application was deployed.
- Lead weekly production releases, database migrations, and SLA-driven incident/service-request work through Freshservice and Jira; troubleshoot Azure Monitor, Application Insights, KQL, OAuth/IAM, database, API, configuration, and network-connectivity issues.
- Remediated exposed credentials across 100+ repositories and built secure Key Vault migration/rollback tooling with discovery, classification, integrity validation, and credential/PII safeguards.
- Co-led production/test server migration and DR work across Windows Server, IIS, Active Directory, firewall, database, application, and load-balancer layers, including a zero-downtime cutover from legacy infrastructure.
- Built internal AI-enabled knowledge and incident-triage tooling that synchronizes Jira, Confluence, and SharePoint context while enforcing credential, PII, provenance, and engineer-review controls.

HBK - Hottinger Brüel & Kjær

Jul 2020 - Feb 2023

DevOps Engineer - Python Automation | Southfield, Michigan / Remote

- Created a Python/Tkinter XML-output automation system that reduced data-processing time by 60%.
- Automated SQL output processing with Python, saving more than 40 hours per month.
- Developed database-configuration tools that streamlined customer onboarding and reduced repetitive setup across application environments.
- Built NSIS installer/uninstaller packages, maintained Git workflows and developer tooling, and provided live technical troubleshooting for customers.

SELECTED ENGINEERING HIGHLIGHTS

CI/CD & Release Engineering

- Standardized delivery for an estate of internal .NET web applications spread across five servers with no prior consistent deployment path, building the repository-to-server-to-deployment-path inventory, a definition generator, reusable Python/.NET templates, and a new folder convention over 157 existing definitions.
- Executed all 28 builds with 27 verified green and validated deployment paths for 25 of 28 applications by dry run on the live deployment agent; zero applications are deployed through the framework yet, pending go/no-go on the first real deployment.
- Pre-deployment validation identified six latent delivery defects before anything shipped, including application-pool identity convergence risk and missing-artifact assumptions against a destructive robocopy /MIR step.

Tech: Azure DevOps YAML, Classic Release, Deployment Groups, Azure DevOps REST APIs, PowerShell, Python, IIS, MSBuild, .NET

SELECTED ENGINEERING HIGHLIGHTS (CONTINUED)

Security & Secrets Remediation

- Built audit and Git-history remediation tooling that removed exposed credentials from 100+ repositories, including historical branches.
- Built a .NET 8 utility for hash-only secret discovery, classification, Azure Key Vault migration, and integrity-verified rollback, backed by 62 automated tests; a measured server run scanned 2,832 files and identified 67 distinct secrets in 25 seconds.

Tech: .NET 8, C#, Azure Key Vault, Managed Identity, xUnit, PowerShell, Python, Git history rewriting

Platform Reliability & Developer Enablement

- Contributed to the Application Insights proof of concept that became the team standard, drove adoption across the legacy application estate, added structured logging where none existed, and authored the team's reusable KQL library.
- Expanded a single-purpose query extractor into a modular ASP.NET Core support portal with per-module access policies, a permanently retained SOX audit trail, DBA approve-only deployment scripts, and 156 automated tests.
- Built Python operations automation for PII-masked database copies, failed-payload triage, and query-to-email workflows, and used usage telemetry to script the retirement of 300+ unused legacy applications.

Tech: Application Insights, Azure Monitor, KQL, Serilog, ASP.NET Core 8, C#, Python, FastAPI, SQL Server, IIS

SELECTED OPEN-SOURCE ENGINEERING

Multi-Agent Engineering Library

github.com/howlcipher/ai_knowledge_library

- Built a filesystem-based knowledge and rules library that loads one canonical rulebook, skill set, and profile context into Claude Code, Codex, and Gemini CLI alike, so agent behavior stays consistent across every terminal assistant.
- Ships 40 domain skills with hallucination guardrails, MCP integrations, and ChromaDB context pruning, packaged with Docker, Helm, and a cross-platform installer, guarded by GitHub Actions running CodeQL, Bandit SAST, and cross-platform tests.

AI Router

github.com/howlcipher/ai_router

- Built a local orchestrator that routes coding-agent tasks across Claude Code, Codex CLI, and Antigravity using task classification, provider health checks, fallback logic, circuit breakers, and cooldown handling.
- Tracks run history in SQLite with structured JSONL run artifacts and captured Git diffs, and enforces safe, Git-aware edit-mode guardrails so agent-driven changes stay reviewable.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

QA Developer, Intrepid Control Systems

Mar 2020 - Apr 2020

- Wrote and executed Mocha test cases for internal software applications and debugged/validated APIs across software and hardware integrations.

Network Engineer, Project Worldwide

Jan 2020 - Mar 2020

- Configured Cisco and Meraki infrastructure across enterprise locations and executed multi-state network migrations with minimal operational downtime.

Network Standards Engineer, Ford Motor Company

Sep 2019 - Dec 2019

- Implemented global network standards and created scalable documentation and IP-management systems for enterprise infrastructure.

IT Network Engineer, Trendset Communications Group

Sep 2015 - Jun 2019

- Enforced network standards, maintained configuration files and documentation, and supported critical production infrastructure.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATION

M.S. Cyber Defense - In Progress - Dakota State University

B.S. Information Technology - Colorado State University Global Campus

B.B.A. Business Administration - Rochester College

CCNA - previously held - Cisco Networking Academy (2014 - 2017)